



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Brazos Christian School
School Website: <https://www.bcseagles.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School (austinclassical.org)

School website audited: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school's public materials consistently emphasize a Christ-centered telos ("glorify Jesus Christ"), the cultivation of wisdom and virtue, the transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty), and the liberal arts (Trivium with Latin, Logic, Rhetoric). They describe memory work, recitation, chanting in Grammar grades; debate, discussion, and Socratic methods in Logic/Rhetoric; senior thesis with oral defense; extensive use of primary sources; and an explicit partnership-with-parents "collaborative" model. The site also evidences chapel and corporate worship practices.

- Most consequential signals: - Purpose: "cultivate wisdom and virtue ... contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful" and "less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about ... an eternal purpose."
- Curriculum: Trivium by stages; Latin 5–8; formal Logic; Rhetoric; primary sources; Great Books/Western tradition; senior thesis/defense.
- Pedagogy: Memorization, recitation, songs and chants (Grammar); debate, discussion, Socratic methods (Logic/Rhetoric); oration and thesis defense; school-wide choir.
- Foundations: Mission, Scripture, doctrine/exegesis/apologetics, chapel.
- Parents & community: Deliberate co-teacher model with training, parent choir in chapel, "partner with your family."

The keyword evaluation below uses the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" as its scoring framework.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Keywords found in the school's materials (examples)

- Positive matches (examples): "glorify Jesus Christ"; "Christian"; "love of God"; "truth, goodness, and beauty"; "Scripture"; "Christian Doctrine," "Exegesis & Hermeneutics," "Apologetics & Ethics"; "image of God"; "church history"; "chapel/Parents Choir"; prayer ("Read and Pray").
- Negative matches: none observed (no "values-neutral," "relativism," or "faith-optional" framing per the lexicon).

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive indicators include transcendental moral realism ("truth, goodness, beauty"), theological grounding (doctrine, exegesis/hermeneutics, apologetics), and communal/liturgical practices (chapel).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: ~16

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- Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Category coverage: 0.90 (strong on theology and transcendentals; specific “liturgy” terms are fewer, though chapel is present)
- 4) Rating: CLASSICAL
- Justification: Mission-level Christocentrism; explicit theological studies integrated across grades; visible communal worship element (chapel).
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- 1) Keywords found (examples)
- Positive: “cultivate wisdom and virtue,” “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful,” “great conversation,” “formation of the whole person,” “eternal purpose,” “Christ-centered.”
 - Minor negative signal: a passing reference to college readiness (“preparing them well for success in college and life”) appears alongside classical aims.
- 2) Comparison to lexicon
- Strong alignment to “formation over information” and pursuit of the transcendentals; only a light brush with “college/life” outcomes language (not dominant).
- 3) Quantitative estimate
- Positive hits: ~10
 - Negative hits: 1
 - Percent positive: 0.91
 - Category coverage: 1.00
- 4) Rating: CLASSICAL
- Justification: The telos is virtue/wisdom and the transcendentals; pragmatist “college and career” framing is not the focus.
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- 1) Keywords found (examples)
- Positive: “Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric),” “Latin,” “Logic,” “Rhetoric,” “primary sources,” “great works of the Western tradition,” “Socratic discussion,” “History” (by eras, not “social studies”), “Senior Thesis (written and oral defense).”
 - Negative: none observed (no “social studies replaces history,” “project-based dominance,” or “STEM-first framing” per lexicon).
- 2) Comparison to lexicon
- Very strong alignment to liberal arts and Great Books/primary texts, integration across disciplines, and historical depth.
- 3) Quantitative estimate
- Positive hits: ~14
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Category coverage: 0.95
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4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Justification: Clear Trivium structure with Latin; upper school load includes primary sources, Socratic work, rhetoric and thesis.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

1) Keywords found (examples)

- Positive: “memorization, recitation, songs” (Grammar); “debate and discussion” (Logic); “Socratic discussion,” “oral/written exams,” “presentations,” “thesis defense” (Rhetoric); “songs, chants, and rhymes fill our grammar school”; school-wide Choir; talk of “leisure” alongside serious study (restful learning posture).
- Negative: none observed (no “project-based-only,” “self-directed/constructivist” emphasis as defining pedagogy).

2) Comparison to lexicon

- Aligns with recitation/chanting, dialectic/Socratic discussion, rhetoric/oratory, and capstone defenses; evidence of contemplative/restful stance.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: ~12
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Category coverage: 0.90

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Justification: Pedagogy closely mirrors classical stages and practices across K–12.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Keywords found (examples)

- Positive: “Head of School who loves Jesus ... teachers who enjoy serving God ... using the classical approach”; “Jesus-loving men and women ... helping form the souls of our children,” “servant leadership” in the curriculum vision.
- Negative: none observed (no reduction of teachers to “facilitators” or purely certification-driven talk in lieu of formation).

2) Comparison to lexicon

- Shows teachers as models of virtue and formation; less explicit “faculty of friends/collegium” language, but the formation emphasis is clear.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: ~4
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Category coverage: 0.60 (fewer explicit “portrait of a teacher/mentor” details on public pages)

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Justification: Strong spiritual/formation posture for faculty is present, but less explicit classical faculty philosophy language publicly available.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Keywords found (examples)

- Positive: “co-laboring with families,” “co-teacher parent,” detailed collaborative schedule with weekly plans and teacher office hours on homeschool days; parent training; Parent Choir in chapel; invitations to tours/information meetings; grandparents club.
- Negative: none observed (no “parents as customers only” language).

2) Comparison to lexicon

- Strong partnership-with-parents ethos, parent formation/training, and robust community practices aligned to classical schooling.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: ~10
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Category coverage: 0.90

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Justification: Deep parent partnership is designed into the model, with training and communal worship opportunities.

Aggregate Rating: CLASSICAL - Category ratings: R&MF CLASSICAL; Purpose CLASSICAL; Curriculum CLASSICAL; Pedagogy CLASSICAL; Faculty SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; Parents/Community CLASSICAL.
- Overall call: CLASSICAL, with a note that publishing a clearer “portrait of a teacher/faculty collegium” would strengthen Element 5.

Notes on the keyword framework used - Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators are taken from “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School,” including items such as truth, goodness, beauty; trivium/quadrivium; Socratic, scholé, wonder; chanting/memorization; partnership with parents; and negatives like “college-and-career readiness” as primary purpose, “values-neutral,” “project-based-only,” etc.

What would move the needle (Faculty) - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” or “Faculty of Friends” statement highlighting mentorship, collegiality, and classical formation for teachers (e.g., faculty seminars in Great Books, shared inquiry). This would raise coverage and clarity for Element 5.

Evidence highlights (select citations) - Mission/Foundations: “exists to glorify Jesus Christ ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students ... classical, Christian education.” - Classical basics: aim/method/tools centered on wisdom/virtue and the transcendentals; Trivium overview. - Trivium by stages; Latin, Logic, Rhetoric; integrated, history-by-era; senior thesis/defense.
- Socratic discussion, primary sources, oral/written exams, presentations. - Grammar memory/recitation/-songs; chants and rhymes; school-wide choir.
- Chapel/parent choir; head’s message with Scripture; parent formation/training.
- ACCS accreditation (spring 2025).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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